

Northwestern University
Dept. of Computer Science

TOMMY M^CMICHEN
mcmichen@u.northwestern.edu

+1 (317) 519-2163
www.mcmichen.cc

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My interests lie in *compilers*, specifically how we can leverage modern programming languages to design general-purpose *intermediate representations* that (1) improve the precision of *static analysis* by preserving high-level information, (2) enable novel *optimizations* on the layout and organization of memory, and (3) open the door to *compiler-runtime codesigns* that rethink existing hardware abstractions.

EDUCATION

Northwestern University , Evanston, Illinois, USA	2020 – 2026
Ph.D. in Computer Science, <i>Advised by Simone Campanoni</i>	2026
M.Sc. in Computer Science, <i>Advised by Simone Campanoni</i>	2023
Rose-Hulman Institute of Technology , Terre Haute, Indiana, USA	2016–2020
B.Sc. in Computer Engineering and Computer Science	

PUBLICATIONS

AI Coding Agents Need Better Compiler Remarks, *CoDAIM 2026*.

Akash Deo, Simone Campanoni, **Tommy McMichen**.

Automatic Data Enumeration for Fast Data Collections, *CGO 2026*.

Tommy McMichen, Simone Campanoni.



Saving Energy with Per-Variable Bitwidth Speculation, *ASPLOS 2025*.

Tommy McMichen, David Dlott, Panitan Wongse-ammatt, Nathan Greiner, Hussain Khajanchi, Russ Joseph, Simone Campanoni.



Representing Data Collections in an SSA Form, *CGO 2024*.

Tommy McMichen, Nathan Greiner, Peter Zhong, Federico Sossai, Atmn Patel, Simone Campanoni.



Getting a Handle on Unmanaged Memory, *ASPLOS 2024*.

Nick Wanninger, **Tommy McMichen**, Simone Campanoni, Peter Dinda.



Program State Element Characterization, *CGO 2023*.

Enrico Armenio Deiana, Brian Suchy, Michael Wilkins, Brian Homerding, **Tommy McMichen**, Katarzyna Dunajewski, Peter Dinda, Nikos Hardavellas, Simone Campanoni.



NOELLE Offers Empowering LLVM Extensions, *CGO 2022*.

Angelo Matni, Enrico Armenio Deiana, Yian Su, Lukas Gross, Souradip Ghosh, Sotiris Apostolakis, Ziyang Xu, Zujun Tan, Ishita Chaturvedi, Brian Homerding, **Tommy McMichen**, David I. August, Simone Campanoni.



Fine-Grained Acceleration using Runtime Integrated Custom Execution (RICE), *CASES 2019*.

Leela Pakanati, **Tommy McMichen**, Zachary Estrada.

INVITED TALKS

“Representing Data Collections for Analysis and Transformation”

Languages, Systems, and Data Seminar, *University of California, Santa Cruz*.

October 2025

Computer Architecture Group Meeting, *University of Cambridge*.

March 2024

Tech Talk, *Rose-Hulman Institute of Technology*.

October 2023

Student Seminar Series, *Northwestern University*.

October 2023

Constellation Workshop, *Northwestern University*.

July 2023

“Towards Collection-Oriented Compilation in LLVM”

LLVM Developers’ Meeting.

October 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Urbana, Illinois, USA

2026 – Present

Postdoctoral Research Associate

• Automatic Compiler Construction

Meta, Menlo Park, California, USA Summer 2025

Software Engineering Intern, Programming Languages and Runtimes, Android Native Compiler Team

- Improved the representation of ClangIR, an open-source C/C++ MLIR compiler.
- Developed analyses and transformations for C++ move semantics in ClangIR.
- Lead ClangIR open-source development efforts through issue creation and code reviews.

Texas Instruments, Dallas, Texas, USA Summer 2019, Summer 2020

Digital Design Engineering Intern, Embedded Processors, Analytics Team

- Performed integration testing for hardware implementation of cache coherence protocol.
- Developed coverage metrics for cache coherence testing.
- Implemented automatic generation of RTL and TLM from descriptor files.

National Instruments, Austin, Texas, USA Summer 2018

R&D Software Engineering Intern, Digitizers

- Designed and implemented FPGA logic for new function generator feature with LabVIEW.
- Added kernel, driver and API support for new function generator feature.
- Implemented full driver stack support for highly-customisable oscilloscope triggers.
- Communicated with multiple teams to add new .NET API entry points.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, *COMP_SCI 322 Compiler Construction*, Prof. Simone Campanoni. Winter 2022

Resident Tutor, *Computer Science and Computer Engineering Departments*. Aug. 2019 – May 2020

SERVICE

Artifact Evaluation Committee, International Symposium on Code Generation and Optimization (CGO). 2027

Student Volunteer, Workshop on Advancing Theory, Research, and Practice for Generative AI in University-Level Computing Education. 2026

Artifact Evaluation Committee, International Conference on Compiler Construction (CC). 2026

Board Member, Computer Science PhD Advisory Council, Northwestern University. 2025 – 2026

Board Member, Computer Science Social Initiative, Northwestern University. 2021 – 2026

Member, CS Ph.D. Orientation Planning Committee, Northwestern University. 2022 – 2025

Member, CS Ph.D. Visit Day Planning Committee, Northwestern University. 2022 – 2026

Student Volunteer, International Symposium on Microarchitecture (MICRO). 2022

Chairperson, IEEE, Rose-Hulman Institute of Technology student branch. 2019 – 2020

Corresponding Secretary, Eta Kappa Nu (HKN), Epsilon Eta Chapter. 2019 – 2020

Member, Eta Kappa Nu (HKN), Epsilon Eta Chapter. 2018 – 2020

AWARDS AND FUNDING

PhD Student Leadership Award, *Northwestern University – CS Department*. 2026

PhD Student Research Award, *Northwestern University – CS Department*. 2026

LLVM Foundation Student Travel Grant, *LLVM Developers' Meeting*. 2025

NSF Student Travel Grant, *ASPLOS*. 2025

NSF Student Travel Grant, *HPCA/PPoPP/CGO*. 2024

NSF Student Travel Grant, *HPCA/PPoPP/CGO*. 2023

IP/ROP Student Travel Award. 2019

NSF Student Travel Grant, *ESweek*. 2019

IP/ROP Student Project Grant. 2018

RESEARCH ADVISING

Leyla Latifova, B.Sc., *Fast Translation Validation for Transformation Pipelines*. 2026 – Present

Akash Deo, M.Sc., *Designing compiler tools for AI-assisted vectorization*. 2025 – 2026 (Apple)

Benjamin Ye, M.Sc., *Characterizing differences between LLVM front-ends.*
Benjamin Ye, B.Sc., *Automatically generating MEMOIR from Rust.*

2025 – Present
2024 – 2025